

A good monsoon

This May has been rather wet, with India as a whole receiving 68.4 per cent more than the normal rainfall for the month **so far**. And it isn't just rain. No record-breaking **temperatures** or significant **heatwaves** **enveloping** large parts of the country **have** been reported. **Intermittent showers** — enabled both by **western disturbance** winds carrying moisture from the Mediterranean Sea towards the Subcontinent and similar **incursions** from the Bay of Bengal and the Arabian Sea — **have** contributed to a wetter and cooler-than-usual summer this time. The pre-monsoon **season** from March 1 to May 23 **has** **cumulatively** reported 16.8 per cent above **long-period average precipitation**, with as many as 27 out of the total 36 **meteorological** subdivisions recording 20 per cent or more **surplus** rain. Each **thunderstorm** has brought down temperatures just when heat conditions were **building up**.

While all these have made the ongoing summer relatively **bearable**, the impact of that, if any, on the monsoon itself remains to be seen. The India Meteorological Department has **forecast** above-normal rainfall for the monsoon season (June-September) based on there being no **El Niño** this time. The **Indian Ocean Dipole**, too, is expected to be in “**neutral**” **state**. These two ocean **indicators** known to influence the monsoon **are** favourable, just as the southwesterly **moisture-laden winds** blowing from the Indian Ocean **are** well **in place**. But the monsoon also depends on **so-called** heat lows developing over northwest India. The **intense** solar **heating** of the landmass during the summer **creates** the low-pressure area that acts as a **suction** device for **drawing in** moist air from the monsoon **trough**. While the monsoon can **turn out deficient** due to the absence of any proper heat low formation, the hope is that it will be **compensated** for by the favourable oceanic and atmospheric wind factors.

A good monsoon will be **the icing on the cake** for an economy that has emerged from a **prolonged** period of high food inflation, roughly between July 2023 and December 2024. The best **measures** of relief on that **front** **are** annual consumer food price inflation falling to a 42-month-low of 1.8 per cent in April and wheat stocks in government warehouses climbing to a four-year-high on May 1. While **that, in conjunction with easing** international food and commodity prices, **offers** some comfort, the monsoon's performance will still matter. Policymakers and economic agents should **brace** themselves **for** the **quantum** of rainfall as well as its **spatial** and **temporal** distribution during the upcoming four-month season being **subpar**. That would seem an outside possibility for now — the monsoon may, for many in the south, have already arrived — but it is not to be **discounted**.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.
- **Envelope** (verb) – To cover something ढकना

Vocabulary

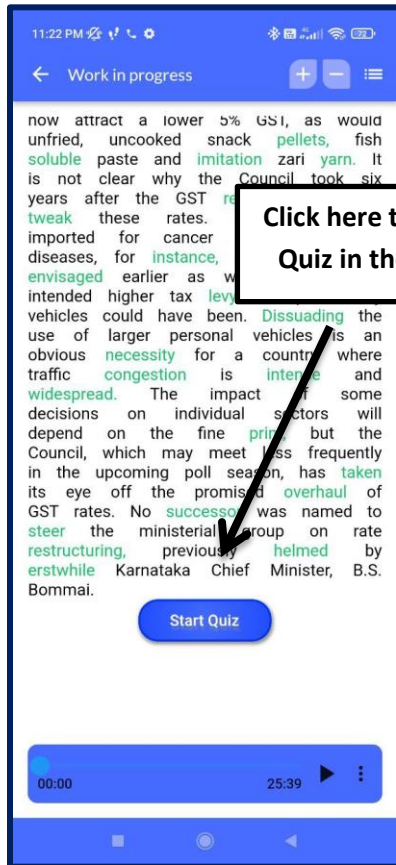
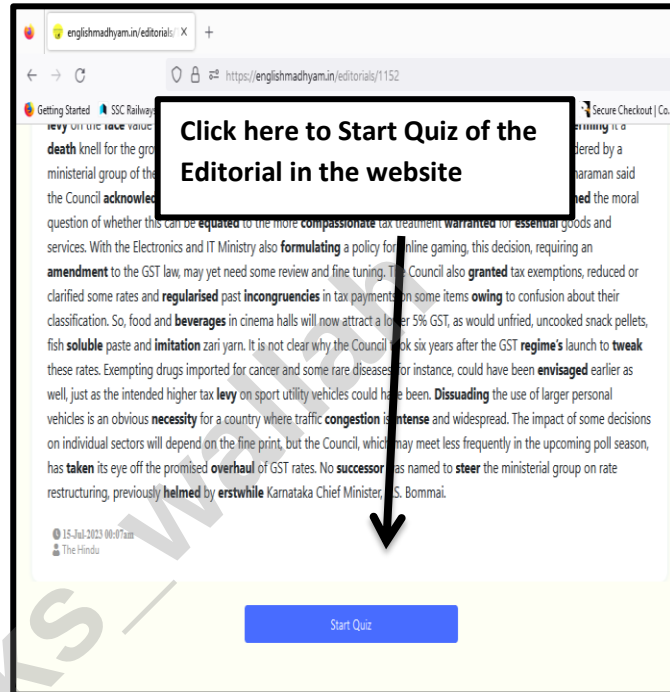
1. **So far** (phrase) – until now, up to this point, as yet, till date, hitherto अब तक
2. **Intermittent** (adjective) – sporadic, occasional, irregular, periodic, on-and-off रुक-रुक कर होने वाला
3. **Shower** (noun) – rain, drizzle, rainfall, precipitation, downpour हल्की बारिश
4. **Western disturbance** (noun) – an extratropical storm originating in the Mediterranean region that brings sudden winter rain to the northwestern parts of the Indian subcontinent पश्चिमी विक्षोभ
5. **Incursion** (noun) – intrusion, invasion, entry, infiltration, penetration प्रवेश
6. **Cumulatively** (adverb) – collectively, altogether, in total, in aggregate, combined कुल मिलाकर
7. **Long-period average precipitation** (noun) – the rainfall recorded over a particular region for a given interval (like month or season) average over a long period like 30years, 50-years etc. दीर्घकालिक औसत वर्षा
8. **Meteorological** (adjective) – weather-related, atmospheric, climatic, climate-related, forecast-based मौसम विज्ञान संबंधी
9. **Surplus** (noun) – excess, overflow, extra, remainder, overabundance अधिशेष
10. **Thunderstorm** (noun) – storm, tempest, squall, lightning storm, electrical storm आंधी-तूफान
11. **Build up** (phrasal verb) – accumulate, intensify, grow, escalate, increase बनना
12. **Bearable** (adjective) – tolerable, manageable, endurable, acceptable, livable सहन करने योग्य
13. **Forecast** (verb) – predict, project, estimate, anticipate, foretell पूर्वानुमान लगाना
14. **El Niño** (noun) – a climate pattern that describes the unusual warming of surface waters in the eastern tropical Pacific Ocean. (प्रशांत महासागर की जलवायु घटना)
15. **Indian Ocean Dipole (IOD)** (noun) – a climate phenomenon characterized by fluctuations in sea surface temperatures and atmospheric conditions in the Indian Ocean हिंद महासागर द्विध्रुव (मॉनसून प्रभावित करने वाला समुद्री पैटर्न)
16. **Neutral** (adjective) – balanced, impartial, inactive, non-aligned, middle तटस्थ
17. **State** (noun) – condition, situation, phase, position, status स्थिति
18. **Moisture-laden** (adjective) – humid, damp, saturated, wet, water-filled नमी से भरा हुआ

19. **In place** (phrase) – ready, established, set, functioning, prepared तैयार / लागू
20. **So-called** (adjective) – supposed, alleged, popularly known, self-styled, nominal तथाकथित
21. **Intense** (adjective) – extreme, severe, strong, fierce, acute तीव्र
22. **Suction** (noun) – vacuum pull, absorption, drawing force, intake, attraction खिंचाव
23. **Draw in** (phrasal verb) – attract, pull in, suck in, bring in, absorb खींचना
24. **Monsoon Trough** (noun) – a low-pressure zone that develops during the monsoon season, typically running parallel to the Himalayan foothills
25. **Turn out** (phrasal verb) – result, happen, prove, emerge, end up साबित होना
26. **Deficient** (adjective) – lacking, insufficient, inadequate, short, incomplete कमी वाला
27. **Compensate** (verb) – make up, balance, offset, repay, redress पूर्ति करना
28. **The icing on the cake** (phrase) – bonus, added benefit, finishing touch, extra pleasure, sweetener सोने पे सुहागा
29. **Prolonged** (adjective) – extended, lengthy, drawn-out, persistent, sustained लंबे समय तक चलने वाला
30. **Front** (noun) – area, aspect, zone, region, sector मोर्चा / क्षेत्र
31. **In conjunction with** (phrase) – together with, in combination with, along with, accompanied by, jointly के साथ मिलकर
32. **Ease** (verb) – reduce, alleviate, relieve, lessen, soften कम करना
33. **Brace** (for) (verb) – prepare, ready, gear up, steel, fortify तैयार रहना
34. **Quantum** (noun) – amount, quantity, volume, measure, magnitude मात्रा
35. **Spatial** (adjective) – geographical, locational, regional, physical, positional स्थानिक
36. **Temporal** (adjective) – time-based, chronological, seasonal, timing-related, transient समय-संबंधी
37. **Subpar** (noun/adjective) – below standard, inferior, underperforming, inadequate, deficient औसत से कम
38. **Discount** (verb) – disregard, dismiss, ignore, undervalue, reject अनदेखा करना / खारिज करना

Summary of the Editorial

1. **May 2025 has been unusually wet**, with India receiving 68.4% more rainfall than the average for the month.
2. The summer so far has also been **cooler**, with no major heatwaves or record-breaking temperatures reported.
3. **Intermittent showers** due to western disturbances and moisture incursions from the Bay of Bengal and Arabian Sea have contributed to this.
4. The **pre-monsoon season (March 1–May 23)** has recorded 16.8% more rainfall than the long-period average.
5. **27 out of 36 meteorological subdivisions** have reported surplus rainfall of 20% or more.
6. Frequent **thunderstorms have suppressed rising temperatures**, offering temporary relief from heat.
7. While the current summer has been **more comfortable**, it is uncertain how this might affect the coming **monsoon**.
8. The **India Meteorological Department (IMD)** has predicted **above-normal monsoon rainfall** for June to September.
9. This forecast is based on **neutral El Niño conditions** and a **neutral Indian Ocean Dipole**, both favorable for the monsoon.
10. **Southwesterly winds** carrying moisture from the Indian Ocean are in place, supporting positive monsoon prospects.
11. However, the monsoon also relies on "**heat lows**" forming over northwest India, which are driven by intense solar heating.
12. Without these **low-pressure zones**, monsoon strength could suffer, though other oceanic and atmospheric conditions may compensate.
13. A **good monsoon** would be a welcome development for an economy recovering from **prolonged high food inflation** (July 2023–Dec 2024).
14. Encouraging signs include **consumer food inflation dropping to 1.8% in April 2025** and **government wheat stocks reaching a 4-year high**.
15. Despite the optimism, **uncertainty remains** around the **quantity, timing, and regional spread** of rainfall, so **policymakers must stay prepared**.

Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based

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